



The Prodigal SON

In ignoring the high command directive to drop a divisive *yatra*, Jaganmohan Reddy's poorly thought gamble may have limited his prospects of climbing up the party ladder

By Amarnath K. Menon

The Congress has a new enfant terrible in Andhra Pradesh. Barely two years after his smooth transformation from a taciturn businessman to an ambitious politician, Y.S. Jaganmohan Reddy, 37, is leaving no stone unturned to emerge as a formidable regional leader. Little wonder then that his gameplan has upped the

ante for the Congress High Command that stopped him from embarking on an *odarpu yatra* (consolation tour) to Warangal district last week. The third in his journey to 23 districts of the state, the *yatra* was meant to call on the families of those who killed themselves soon after his father Y.S. Rajasekhara Reddy's death in a helicopter crash last year and offer them a personal grant of Rs 1 lakh ahead of his father's first death anniversary.

Attempts to persuade him to put the travel plans on hold fell on deaf ears. And as Reddy went ahead with the *yatra*, the Andhra Pradesh Police took him into preventive custody from a train at the wayside Vangapalli station and sent him home. Meanwhile, the rival Telangana Rashtra Samithi (TRS) supporters had already launched a protest against Reddy's tour. The situation worsened to an extent that the agitators started throw-